



Duracell's child safety measure
Duracell's new coin batteries have a bitter coating that makes them taste terrible. <http://dgit.in/oct20-57>



Disney Plus GroupWatch
The service is launching a new feature that allows you to watch Disney Plus with friends, remotely. <http://dgit.in/oct20-58>

NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3080 Graphics Card

More bling bling for the same dough

After two whole years, we're looking at the next major GPU launch cycle with NVIDIA Ampere RTX 30 series and AMD's RDNA2 RX 6000 cards right around the corner. At Rs 71,000, the RTX 3080 has the same launch price as the RTX 2080, the RTX 3080 doesn't have to convince gamers. It supposedly even beats the RTX 2080 Ti which costs a lot more. But by what margin? Let's figure that out.

NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3080 Specifications

The RTX 3080 and RTX 3070 are similar to the RTX 2080 and RTX 2070 in terms of positioning. The RTX 3080 in particular has 8704 CUDA cores. We have six GPCs within the GA102 GPU for the RTX 3080 but there's asymmetry with the GPC configuration. There are 4 GPCs which have 12 SMs each and there are two GPUs with 10 SMs in them. Overall, we're looking at 68 SMs with a total with 8704 CUDA cores in all. Then you have 272 3rd Gen Tensor Cores and 68 2nd Gen RT cores. Coming to the memory, we're looking at 10 GB of GDDR6X memory on the RTX 3080. The inclusion of GDDR6 allows for a total bandwidth of 760 GB/s which when compared to the RTX 2080 Super's 496 GB/s, is quite the improvement.

Performance

3DMark

The RTX 3080 scores 10959 in Fire Strike Ultra which puts it 68.4 per cent ahead of the RTX 2080 and 35 per cent ahead of the RTX 2080 Ti.

Time spy shows a relatively conservative 54.5 per cent lead over the RTX 2080 and a 30 per cent lead over the RTX 2080 Ti.

Basemark GPU

The RTX 3080 achieves scores that are between 66-81 per cent greater

than the RTX 2080 and about 26-31 per cent greater than the RTX 2080 Ti. Surprisingly, Ampere's OpenGL performance has improved the most.

Blender

The RTX 3080 finished the classroom scene in 1m 18s which is a decent 4 seconds lesser than the RTX 2080 Ti.

IndigoBench

The RTX 3080 clocked in at 35.751 M Samples/sec which is 18.9 per cent more than the RTX 2080 Ti and 56.4 per cent more than the RTX 2080.

Unigine SuperPosition

The RTX 3080 performs 17.5 per cent better than the RTX 2080 Ti and 49 per cent better than the RTX 2080.

Death Stranding

We saw the RTX 3080 perform about 23 per cent better than the RTX 2080 at 1080p and 1440p and about 11-15 per cent better than the RTX 2080 Ti.

Doom Eternal

Performance metrics for Doom Eternal put the RTX 3080 a good 2x over the RTX 2080 and 1x over the RTX 2080 Ti. And we're talking 4K here.

Power consumption and thermals

During most of our benchmarks we



PERFORMANCE.....90
VALUE.....75

didn't see the RTX 3080 go over 65 degrees celsius. The entire card is a massive heatsink so it has that in its favour. While cooling has been achieved, one needs to examine why such a beefy cooler was needed in the first place.

In some benchmarks, we saw the RTX 3080 consume 320 watts consistently. Peak power consumption would hit 335 watts quite frequently which is a ridiculous amount for the graphics card. We can only imagine what the RTX 3090 would be.

Bottomline

The NVIDIA GeForce RTX 3080 easily beats the RTX 2080 by about 30-70 per cent. In some titles, it even achieves 2x the performance. It even runs cooler than previous gen reference cards. If you're looking for a flagship GPU to own, this is it. We're still going to wait for the AMD RDNA GPUS in the form of the RX 6000 series but by the looks of it, AMD has a tough job if it wants the performance crown.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CUDA CORES: 8704 | TENSOR CORES: 272 | RT CORES: 68
| LITHOGRAPHY: 8nm Samsung | TDP: 320W | MEMORY:
10GB GDDR6X | MEMORY BANDWIDTH: 760 GB/s

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